

₹250 Average revenue per user in Q1FY26, the first time a telecom player has hit this milestone in India

FLAGSHIP BOOST

• Bharti Airtel led the surge in group profits with a near 478% YoY jump in PAT

PAT Rank	Company Name	Gross Sales (in ₹crore)			Profit After Tax (in ₹crore)			
		FY24	FY25	Growth (In %)	FY24	FY25	Growth (In %)	Promoter Stake (in %*)
8	Bharti Airtel	149,982	172,985	15.3	8,558	37,481	338	51.3
41	Indus Towers	28,601	30,123	5.3	6,036	9,932	64.5	50
171	Bharti Hexacom	7,089	8,548	20.6	504	1,494	196.1	70

NOTE *PROMOTERS' STAKE AS OF JUNE 2025 **SOURCE** ACE EQUITY

56 | witnessed 196.1% and 64.5% YoY increase in PAT, respectively.

Ravi Singh, Senior Vice President of Retail Research at Religare Broking, attributes this to significant subscriber growth, higher ARPU (average revenue per user), and rollout of 5G services. “The group also benefited from operational efficiencies, cost optimisation, and a shift towards high-margin services. The profit surge was underpinned by strong momentum in both India and Africa operations, supported by higher-paying smartphone subscriber additions, increased data usage, and tariff hikes in the previous year,” says Singh.

Singh says on the non-telecom front, Bharti Enterprises’ diversification into real estate, renewable energy, and strategic investments also contributed to the earnings growth. “Strategic debt reduction and prudent capital allocation strengthened the group’s financial position,” says Singh.

5G, PREMIUMISATION AND AFRICA

The momentum continued into Q1FY26, with Bharti Airtel’s consolidated net profit jumping 43% YoY to ₹5,948 crore. Revenue from operations grew 28% to ₹49,463 crore.

The mobile segment was the mainstay, adding 1.2 million customers, including 3.9 million smartphone users. The postpaid segment reported a net addition of

0.7 million, which accounted for 57% of all additions. ARPU ticked up to ₹250, the first for an Indian telecom player. The 5G push stayed on track, with 152 million users on the network. “We continue to believe that 5G handset adoption at the bottom end of the market will accelerate with more affordable options...5G sites already cater to 36% of the total network traffic, enabling some traffic offload from the existing 4G sites as well,” said Vittal.

In the broadband segment, Airtel clocked its highest-ever quarterly net additions at 939,000, with fixed wireless access gaining traction through 540,000 new users.

In entertainment, the story was mixed. Airtel lost around 200,000 direct-to-home customers but more than made up for it with fast-rising Internet Protocol Television adoption.

The enterprise arm held its ground, delivering revenues of ₹5,060 crore. Stripping out the discontinued low-margin business, the segment grew 2% sequentially. “The outlook continues to be strong, with a strong visibility on funnel and the order book,” said Vittal.

Meanwhile, Airtel Payments Bank crossed 98 million monthly transacting users in June and a revenue run-rate of ₹3,100 crore, up 27% YoY. Deposits climbed 29% to ₹3,750 crore, signaling growing trust in Airtel’s fintech ecosystem.

The group’s business in Africa fuelled the strength,